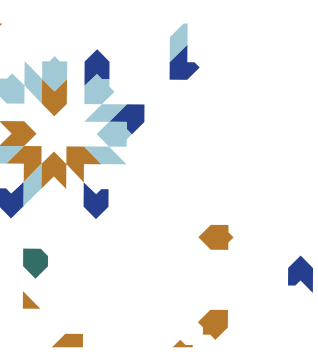




THE COMPREHENSIVE GUIDE TO LEVANTINE ARABIC (INTERMEDIATE LEVEL)

الدَّليل الشَّامِل للعَرَبِيَّة الشَّامِيَّة (للمُسْتَوَى المُتَوَسِّط)

This book provides a framework for building your proficiency at the Intermediate Level in Levantine Arabic in the following areas: reading, writing, listening, and speaking.

Mohammad K. Ayaseh

A special thanks to the following individuals for their time, contributions, and edits to this book:

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Huda Abdul-Hamid
Saif Hamadallah
Amanda Whelan
Adriana Wojtukowicz
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The Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan
The Deposit Number at The National Library
(2022/5/2541)

418.2

Ayaseh, Mohammad Kamal

The Comprehensive Guide to Levantine Arabic (Intermediate Level)/
Mohammad Kamal Mohammad Ayaseh.- Amman: The Author, 2022

() P.

Deposit No.: (2022/5/2541)

Descriptors: /Second Language Teaching//Vernacular Languages//Arabic
Language/

يُتَحَمَّلُ الْمُؤَلِّفُ كَامِلَ الْمَسْئُولِيَّةِ الْقَانُونِيَّةِ عَنْ مَحْتَوَى مُصَنَّفِهِ وَلَا يُعْبَرُ هَذَا الْمَصْنَفُ عَنْ دَائِرَةِ الْمَكْتَبَةِ الْوُطْنِيَّةِ أَوْ أَيِّ
جِهَةٍ حُكُومِيَّةٍ أُخْرَى.

ISBN 979-8242-7188-45

Published 2022
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- 150 SELF-STUDY HOURS

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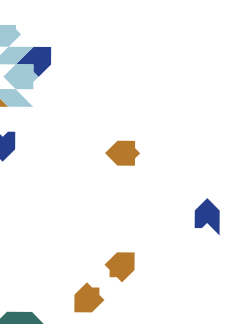
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Acknowledgements

This comprehensive guide is the product of countless hours and cycles of revising, modifying, and updating. Truly, without the assistance and expertise of the following individuals, this book would not have become a reality.

First and foremost, I would like to thank all of my Arabic language students and friends for trusting me and believing in me as their teacher. They have inspired and motivated me to improve my knowledge and to write this book.

Thanks to Duaa Allan for all of the early mornings and late nights whilst we created Deewan together. I also want to thank my wonderful team at Deewan for their contributions to this book.

I would like to express my gratitude to Hussein Abdullah for his relentless dedication in designing this book.

Thanks to my family for their patience whilst I sacrificed my time with them to tackle this labour of love, and especially my mother, who has taken the brunt of that sacrifice. I owe all of my accomplishments to her.

Sincerely,

Mohammad K. Ayaseh

Introduction

The Levant Area, also called Bilad Al-Sham, is the eastern coastal strip of the Mediterranean Sea and consists of Jordan, Palestine, Syria, and Lebanon. Levantine Arabic is considered the dialect that most resembles Modern Standard Arabic (MSA), and is one of the five major Arabic dialects, with over 50 million native speakers.

Although Levantine Arabic is used colloquially for daily conversations in the Levant, the currently available curriculum books focus on MSA rather than actual spoken dialect. To the best of my knowledge, this book is the first of its kind as it covers the fundamentals of Levantine Arabic.

This book is a culmination of my experience teaching MSA and Levantine Arabic to hundreds of students from all around the world. It is the result of my efforts to meet the essential linguistic needs of Arabic language students, and for them to build a strong base in the spoken dialect.

One of the essential goals when writing this book was to simplify and solidify the way language instruction

is provided to non-native speakers. Therefore, this book utilizes a technique that we use at Deewan Institute called *the Ladder of Words*. Each lesson builds on the vocabulary and structures from prior lessons. Students build familiarity with the words and become progressively aware of the patterns and structures in the Arabic language as they practice reading, writing, listening, and speaking.

I have aimed to make this book user-friendly, with or without a teacher. Each lesson starts with clearly stated goals, followed by structured lessons, supplementary exercises, and recorded readings. Each lesson ends with a checklist for students (and teachers) to monitor their progress.

The Comprehensive Guide to Levantine Arabic is not intended only for Beginner Level students, but also to fill the gaps for any Arabic student at any level. It is my hope that this book facilitates both the acquisition and reinforcement of the Levantine Arabic language for students of all levels.

How to use this book

This book, *The Comprehensive Guide to Levantine Arabic (Intermediate Level)*, is your roadmap for moving from Intermediate Low (B1) to Intermediate Mid (B2). Think of it as a training plan: every chapter adds new skills and gives you the tools to speak more naturally, read more confidently, and understand real conversations.

Follow these steps to make the most of it:

1. FOLLOW THE PATH

The book is built step by step. Start where you are, but don't skip around too much because each lesson prepares you for the next.

Chapter 1 (Building with Verbs – B1): Learn future tense, imperative forms, irregular verbs, and verb patterns (1–10). These are the engines of Arabic sentences.

Chapter 2 (Expanding Structures – B2): Master possessives, comparisons, prepositions, and broken plurals. These make your sentences richer and more precise.

Chapter 3 (Speaking with Fluency – B2): Tackle transition words, feelings, jobs, and healthcare. This is where you move beyond “getting by” into expressing complex thoughts. Even if you already know some of the topics, review them because you will always pick up something new.

2. USE THE LESSON TOOLS

Each lesson is designed to help you build both accuracy and fluency.

Lesson Overview: A quick map of what you will learn.

Ladder of Words: The key vocabulary for that lesson. Write them on flashcards (paper or digital).

Daily Expressions: Practical phrases that you can try in real life the same day you learn them.

Audio Files: Listen, repeat, and shadow (speak along with the recording). The QR code at the start of the lesson gives you access.

3. STUDY SMART

Here is how to get the most out of every lesson.

1. **Listen First.** Play the audio before reading. Try to catch words you already know.
2. **Read and Repeat.** Go through the dialogues and texts out loud. Do not just read silently.
3. **Build Vocabulary.** Put every new word in your flashcard system and test yourself daily.
4. **Practice Speaking.** Use the dialogues as templates. Swap words, change situations, and make them your own.
5. **Check Yourself.** At the end of the lesson, use the Self-Check to see what is clear and what you need to review.

4. BRING ARABIC INTO YOUR LIFE

Describe your day using the new grammar such as comparisons or prepositions.

Use Daily Expressions when talking to friends, classmates, or teachers.

Record yourself speaking and listen back because it is one of the fastest ways to improve. Write short conversations using the Ladder of Words, then act them out with a partner or teacher.

5. KEEP GROWING BEYOND THE BOOK

At the back, you will find a Glossary of Words. Do not just read it, expand it.

Add your own notes and example sentences. Create a personal dictionary in a notebook or app.

Review it regularly, especially words you use in your daily life.

FINAL ADVICE

This book is a practice guide, not just a reference. Do not be passive—speak, write, listen, and repeat. The more you use Arabic, the faster you will improve.

Progress comes from action. Make Arabic part of your daily life, and this book will help you get there.

How to improve your Arabic

Vocalising your Arabic is an important part of learning the language. Make sure, when listening to the audio, that you repeat what you hear, pausing as required, and also say the words while the audio is playing to ensure your pronunciation is correct. It is always a good idea to record yourself and listen back so you can compare it to the audio and check your pronunciation.

In order to improve your understanding of different Arabic words, and to help with memorisation, make connections between words, for example: find synonyms of words along with their antonyms and try to use them in different contexts. Always write them down and store them with your learnt vocabulary.

Another great way to improve your Arabic is to write simple sentences, conversations and stories in your own

language; then replace the words in the texts with their Arabic equivalent, once you have learnt them, in order to help you practise using the Arabic words you have learnt. Over time of learning more and more Arabic, keep adding more Arabic words to the same sentences, conversations and stories until the whole text turns to Arabic. In this way, you make sure you are practising the words and expressions you learn from the book as you learn them. This helps a great deal with memorisation.

Further learning can be done by using the texts given in the book. The words from these texts can be replaced with synonyms or antonyms, in order to broaden your Arabic vocabulary and enhance your Arabic language.



Chapter 1

- **Lesson 1** – Verb Conjugation (Future and Imperative)
- **Lesson 2** – Form I Irregular Verbs and Conjugation
- **Lesson 3** – The Ten Verb Forms
- **Lesson 4** – Verb With Pronouns
- **Lesson 5** – Forms 2-10 (Verb Conjugation)



SCAN ME

To access the audio files for this chapter, scan the QR code. This will take you to a OneDrive folder where you can download the audio files directly. If you experience any issues, please contact: management@deewanainstitute.com

Lesson 1

Conjugating Form 1 Regular Verbs - Future and Imperative Tenses

In this lesson you will learn:

- A) Conjugate Form 1 Regular Verbs in Future and Imperative Tenses. [Section 1.1](#)
- B) Practice through Comprehension Exercises. [Section 1.2](#)
- C) Expand vocabulary with the Ladder of Words. [Section 1.3](#)
- D) Learn common “Daily Expressions”. [Section 1.4](#)



To access the audio files for this lesson, scan the QR code. This will take you to a YouTube channel where you can listen to the audio files directly.

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SCAN ME

Section 1.1

تَصْرِيفُ الْأَفْعَالِ الْمُنتَظِمَةِ الْمُسْتَقْبَلِ وَالْأَمْرِ

Form 1 Verb Conjugation Future and Imperative

Form 1 verbs are the verbs which consist of three letters. The regular type of these verbs is the type which does not have long vowels (i.e., ي، و، ا) in it. Such verbs are divided in the following subcategories:

- Verbs that begin with ََ such as كَتَبَ، دَرَسَ، قَرَأَ
- Verbs that begin with ِِ such as شَرِبَ، نَزَلَ، عَمِلَ
- Verbs that begin with Hamzeh ُ such as أَكَلَ / أَخَذَ

The conjugation of the above-mentioned subcategories is regular. Nothing happens to the root of the verb. We only add the prefixes and suffixes according to the tense and pronouns. Notice that the short vowel of the second root letter is not fixed and keeps changing. You will have to depend on your familiarity with the verbs to know that short vowel of the second root letter.

In Arabic, the imperative الْأَمْر mood serves to ask, request, or command someone to perform an action. Form I regular verbs align with the pattern of فَعَلَ. The imperative form is derived by replacing the prefix baa' of the present tense (third-person masculine singular) with alif and kasrah (اِ) and adheres to one of the following patterns: اِفْعَلْ، اِفْعَلْ، اِفْعَلْ.

Note: In some cases, the vowel on the prefix بُ remains the harakeh.

For example, with the verb كَتَبَ (he wrote):

1. The third-person masculine singular form in the present tense is يُكْتُبُ.
2. To derive the imperative, replace baa' with alif, resulting in the imperative form اُكْتُبْ.

Note: To negate imperative verbs, one may use either of the negation tools لا or ما. These negation tools must precede the future form of the verb

Conjugating Regular Verbs

قَعَدَ (يَقْعُدُ) to sit

الضَّمِير Pronouns	الماضي Past Tense	المُضارع Present Tense	المُسْتَقْبَلُ Future Tense	الأَمْرُ Imperative
هُوَ	قَعَدَ	يَقْعُدُ / يَقْعُدُ	رَحَ يَقْعُدُ	-
هِيَ	قَعَدَتْ	تَقْعُدُ	بِذِّهَا تَقْعُدُ	-
هُمْ	قَعَدُوا	يَقْعُدُوا	لَا زِمَ يَقْعُدُوا	-
إِنَّتَ	قَعَدْتَ / قَعَدْتُ	تَقْعُدُ	الْمَفْرُوضُ تَقْعُدُ	أَقْعُدْ
إِنَّتِ	قَعَدْتِ	تَقْعُدِي	قَبْلَ مَا تَقْعُدِي	أَقْعُدِي
إِنَّتُو	قَعَدْتُوا	تَقْعُدُوا	بَعْدَ مَا تَقْعُدُوا	أَقْعُدُوا
أَنَا	قَعَدْتُ / قَعَدْتُ	بَقْعُدُ	صَعِبَ أَقْعُدُ	-
إِحنَا/نِحنَا	قَعَدْنَا	نَقْعُدُ	إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ نَقْعُدُ	-

أمثلة Examples	مُقابله بالإنجليزي Equivalent in English
١ - بِذِّي أَقْعُدُ عَلَى هَذَا الْكُرْسِيِّ.	1 - I want to sit on that chair.
٢ - عِيلَتِي قَعَدُوا فِي تَايْلَنْدَ أُسْبُوعَيْنِ.	2 - My family stayed in Thailand for two weeks.
٣ - كُلَّ يَوْمٍ إِمُّهُ تَقْعُدُ عَلَى نَارٍ وَهِيَ تَسْتَنَاهُ.	3 - His mother worries every day while waiting for him. <i>Literally: His mother sits on fire every day while waiting for him.</i>
٤ - قَعَدَ يَحْكِيهِ عَنْ مَشَاكِلِهِ.	4 - He kept talking to him about his problems. <i>Literally: He sat talking to him about his problems</i>
٥ - أَقْعُدْ عَلَى قَلْبِي.	5 - Stay close to my heart (in a loving way). <i>Literally: Sit on my heart</i>

عَزَمَ (يَعْزِمُ) to invite (informal)

الضَّمِير Pronouns	الماضي Past Tense	المُضارع Present Tense	المُسْتَقْبَلُ Future Tense	الأَمْرُ Imperative
هُوَ	عَزَمَ	يَعْزِمُ	رَحَّ يَعْزِمُ	-
هِيَ	عَزَمَتْ	تَعْزِمُ	بِدَّهَا تَعْزِمُ	-
هُمْ	عَزَمُوا	يَعْزِمُوا	لَا زِمَ يَعْزِمُوا	-
إِنَّتَ	عَزَمْتُ / عَزَمْتَ	تَعْزِمُ	الْمَفْرُوضُ تَعْزِمُ	إِعْزِمِ
إِنَّتِ	عَزَمْتِ	تَعْزِمِي	قَبْلَ مَا تَعْزِمِي	إِعْزِمِي
إِنَّتو	عَزَمْتُوا	تَعْزِمُوا	بَعْدَ مَا تَعْزِمُوا	إِعْزِمُوا
أَنَا	عَزَمْتُ / عَزَمْتَ	بَعْزِمُ	صَعِبَ أَعْزِمُ	-
إِحنَا/نِحنَا	عَزَمْنَا	نَبْعَزِمُ	إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ نَعْزِمُ	-

Hints:

- In the past tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **you** (masc.) and **I** is identical.
- In the present tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.
- In the future tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.

Note: The words in red are examples of the keywords used with the future tense.

مُقابِلُهُ بِالْإِنْجِلِيزِي Equivalent in English	أَمْثِلَةٌ Examples
1 - We will invite them to our house next week.	١ - رَحَّ نَعْزِمُهُمْ عَلَى بَيْتِنَا الْأُسْبُوعِ الْجَايِ.
2 - They invited me to breakfast, but I didn't go.	٢ - عَزَمُونِي عَلَى الْفَطُورِ بَسَ مَا رُجِحْتُ.
3 - Every month, she invites me for coffee at the café, and I invite her for mansaf.	٣ - كُلَّ شَهْرٍ بَتَعْزِمُنِي عَلَى قَهْوَةٍ فِي الْمَقْهَى وَأَنَا بَعْزِمُهَا عَلَى مَنْسَفٍ.

List of Verbs that Begin with ٠٠

The verb (its preposition)	الفِعْلُ (حَرْفُ جَرِّهِ)
he wrote / to write	كَتَبَ - ٠٠٠
he sent / to send (to)	بَعَثَ - ٠٠٠ لَ... / عَلَى
he paid / to pay (to, for) he pushed / to push	دَفَعَ - ٠٠٠ لَ... / عَنْ
he ordered / to order (from) he asked for/ to ask for	طَلَبَ - ٠٠٠ مِنْ
he read / to read	قَرَأَ - ٠٠٠

رَجَعَ (بِرَجَعَ) to return

الضمير Pronouns	الماضي Past Tense	المضارع Present Tense	المستقبل Future Tense	الأمر Imperative
هُوَ	رَجَعَ	يَرْجَعُ	رَحَّ يَرْجَعُ	-
هِيَ	رَجَعَتْ	يَتَرَجَّعُ	بِدَّهَا تَرْجَعُ	-
هُمْ	رَجَعُوا	يَرْجَعُونَ	لَا زِمَ يَرْجَعُونَ	-
إِنَّتَ	رَجَعْتُ / رَجِعْتُ	يَتَرَجَّعُ	الْمَفْرُوضُ تَرْجَعُ	ارْجَعْ
إِنَّتِ	رَجَعْتِ	يَتَرَجَّعِي	قَبْلَ مَا تَرْجَعِي	ارْجَعِي
إِنَّتو	رَجَعْتُوا	يَتَرَجَّعُونَ	بَعْدَ مَا تَرْجَعُونَ	ارْجَعُوا
أَنَا	رَجَعْتُ / رَجِعْتُ	يَرْجَعُ	صَعِبَ أَرْجَعُ	-
إِحنَا/نِحنَا	رَجَعْنَا	يَنْرَجِعُ	إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ نَرْجَعُ	-

Hints:

- In the past tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **you** (masc.) and **I** is identical.
- In the present tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.
- In the future tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.

Note: The words in red are examples of the keywords used with the future tense.

مُقابِلُهُ بِالْإِنْجِلِيزِي Equivalent in English	أَمْثِلَةٌ Examples
1 - I will return to Jordan tomorrow.	١ - رَجَعَ أَرْجِعْ عَلَى الْأُرْدُنْ بُكْرًا.
2 - They are talking about the same topic again. Literally: They returned to talking about the same topic.	٢ - رَجَعُوا يَحْكُوا بِنَفْسِ الْمَوْضُوعِ.
3 - She returned to her husband after a week.	٣ - رَجَعَتْ لَزَوْجِهَا بَعْدَ أُسْبُوعٍ.
4 - His health deteriorated Literally: His health went back.	٤ - صَحَّتُهُ رَجَعَتْ لَوْرًا.
5 - Reverse the car. Literally: Go back with the car.	٥ - إِرْجِعْ بِالسَّيَّارَةِ لَوْرًا.

List of Verbs that Begin with َ َ َ

الْفِعْلُ (حَرْفُ جَرِّهِ)	The verb (its preposition)
عَمِلَ - َ َ َ	he did / to do he made / to make
عَرَفَ - َ َ َ عَنْ	he knew / to know (about) he recognized / to recognize
سَمِعَ - َ َ َ عَنْ / بِ	he listened / to listen (about) he heard / to hear
لَعِبَ - َ َ َ بِ، فِي، مَعَ	he played / to play (with)
طَلَعَ - َ َ َ عَلَى	he went out, up / to go out, up he left / to leave (to) he turned out/ to turn out

Pattern of Conjugation Verbs َ َ and َ َ

الأمر Imperative	المُسْتَقْبَلُ Future Tense	المُضَارِعُ Present Tense	الماضي Past Tense	الضَّمِيرُ Pronouns
-	رَحْ يَ	يَ		هُوَ
-	بَدَّهَا تَ	تَ	تَ	هِيَ
-	وا لازم يَ	وا	وا	هُمْ
إِ	المَفْرُوضُ تَ	تَ	تَ	إِنَّتَ
يَ	يَ	يَ	يَ	إِنَّتَ
وا	وا	وا	توا	إِنَّتو
-	صَعِبَ أ		تَ	أَنَا
-	إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ نَ		سنا	إِحْنَا/نَحْنَا

Conjugating Verbs that Begin with Hamzeh

أَكَلَ (بَاكُلُ) to eat

الأمر Imperative	المُسْتَقْبَلُ Future Tense	المُضَارِعُ Present Tense	الماضي Past Tense	الضَّمِيرُ Pronouns
-	رَحْ يَأْكُلْ	بَاكُلُ	أَكَلَ	هُوَ
-	بَدِّهَا تَأْكُلْ	بَتَاكُلُ	أَكَلَتْ	هِيَ
-	لَا زِمَ يَأْكُلُوا	بَاكُلُوا	أَكَلُوا	هُمْ
كُلْ	الْمَفْرُوضُ تَأْكُلْ	بَتَاكُلُ	أَكَلْتُ / أَكَلْتُ	إِنْتَ
كُلِي	قَبْلَ مَا تَأْكُلِي	بَتَاكُلِي	أَكَلْتِ	إِنْتِ
كُلُوا	بَعْدَ مَا تَأْكُلُوا	بَتَاكُلُوا	أَكَلْتُمْ	إِنْتُمْ
-	صَعِبَ أَكُلْ	بَاكُلُ	أَكَلْتُ / أَكَلْتُ	أَنَا
-	إِنْ شَاءَ اللَّهُ نَأْكُلْ	بِنَاكُلُ	أَكَلْنَا	إِحْنَا/نَحْنَا

Hints:

- In the past tense, the conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **you** (masc.) and **I** is identical.
- In the present tense, the Hamzeh is omitted, and we use Alif only. The conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.
- In the future tense, the Hamzeh is omitted, and we use Alif only. The conjugation of the verb with the pronouns **she** and **you** (masc.) is identical.

Note: The words in red are examples on the keywords used with the future tense.

Note: The imperative from the verbs starting with hamzeh follow the pattern فُلْ.

مُقابِلُهُ بِالْإِنْجِلِيزِي Equivalent in English	أَمْثِلَةٌ Examples
1 - Eat from this restaurant, it's very delicious.	١ - كُلِّي مِنْ هَادِ الْمَطْعَمِ كَثِيرًا زَاكِي.
2 - Salma fell for the prank <i>Literally: Salma ate the prank.</i>	٢ - رَجِعُوا يَحْكُوا بِنَفْسِ الْمَوْضُوعِ.
3 - Tomorrow, I will study the book intensely. <i>Literally: Tomorrow, I will eat the book.</i>	٣ - رَجَعْتُ لَزَوْجِهَا بَعْدَ أُسْبُوعٍ.
4 - Every time, he takes away my rights. <i>Literally: Every time, he eats my right.</i>	٤ - كُلَّ مَرَّةٍ يَأْكُلُ حَقِّي.
5 - Enough, stop nagging me about this topic. <i>Literally: Enough, stop eating my head with this topic.</i>	٥ - خَلِّصْ لَا تَأْكُلْ رَاسِي بِهَادِ الْمَوْضُوعِ.

أ List of Verbs that Begin with أ

الْفِعْلُ (حَرْفُ جَرْهُ)	The verb (its preposition)
أَكَلَ - أَكُلُ	he ate / to eat
أَخَذَ - أَخُذُ	he took / to take
أَمَرَ - أُمِرُ	he commanded / to command

Pattern of Conjugation Verbs Beginning with Hamzeh

الضَّمِير Pronouns	الماضي Past Tense	المُضارع Present Tense	المُسْتَقْبَل Future Tense	الأمر Imperative
هُوَ	بَي	لِيَشِ مَا يَ	-	-
هِيَ	سَتْ بَتْ	بِدَّهَا تَ	-	-
هُمْ	وَا بَي	وَا لَازِمِ يَ	وَا	-
إِنَّتَ	سَتْ بَتْ	بِدَّكَ تَ	-	-
إِنَّتِ	سَتْ بَتْ	يَ قَبْلَ مَا تَ	يَ	يَ
إِنَّتو	سَتْوَا بَتْ	وَا بَعْدَ مَا تَ	وَا	وَا
أَنَا	سَتْ بَ	رَحَ آ	-	-
إِحْنَا/نَحْنَا	سَنَا بَدْ	يَلَّا نَ	-	-